

1

LESSON

Welcome, diagnostic and classroom English

Week 1: Feelings and settling in · The lesson that tells you how to teach the other 23

Can-do	I can greet people, spell my name out loud, use classroom English, and say and understand numbers.
Grammar	be: I am, you are, he is, she is. Question forms: What is your name? How old are you?
Phonology	The alphabet, with attention to the vowels E, I, A, and to G / J, which French speakers reverse.
Lexis	Classroom English phrases; cardinal numbers to 100; greetings.
Feeds the final task	Letter-by-letter spelling is the mechanic behind the Week 5 acrostic. The diagnostic sets the three writing tiers used in Week 6 Lesson 2.

Materials and preparation

Item	Source file in the Unit 1 bank	Prepare
Numbers sheet	1. Emotions / Numbers2024.docx	Print 11. Use the CARDINAL section only. Ordinals belong to Week 2 Lesson 2.
Classroom English	Build: eight phrases on A3, laminated for the wall	One wall poster plus 11 pocket-size cards for the notebook.
Diagnostic slip	Build: half a page, see the flow below	Print 11 plain, plus 4 with the sentence-starter frame.
Name cards	Folded card and markers	Students write their own first name, large, both sides.
Final task teaser	Final Task Suggestions / myshield.pdf, or a mask from last year	One physical example to hold up for 60 seconds.

Lesson flow, 55 minutes

Time	Stage	What happens	Teacher notes
0 to 5	Door greeting	Greet each student individually in English at the door: <i>Hello, good morning, how are you?</i> They answer and take a name card. Names written large, folded, placed on the desk.	This is your first data point. Note who answers, who freezes, who answers in French.
5 to 13	Classroom English	Introduce eight survival phrases: <i>How do you say ... in English? Can you repeat, please? I do not understand. How do you spell it? Can I have a ...? Sorry, I am late. What page? Can you help me?</i> Choral drill, then pairs, then a phrase race.	Set the rule now: these eight phrases mean nobody needs French. Put the poster on the wall this lesson, not later.
13 to 23	Alphabet and spelling names	Alphabet chant, twice. Then the spelling chain: each student says <i>My name is Louise, L-O-U-I-S-E</i> and the next student repeats the previous name before giving their own.	With 11 students the chain takes one full circuit. Correct G and J, and the vowel E, every time. They will need this in Week 5.
23 to 32	Numbers	Cardinal numbers warm-up from Numbers2024. Calculation strip in pairs, then a phone-number dictation: one partner dictates a made-up eight-digit number, the other writes it, then they swap and check.	Skip the ordinal sections of the sheet entirely. Fold the page or cross them out before copying.
32 to 45	Diagnostic	Part A, written, 10 minutes. Write five sentences about yourself. No dictionary, no phone. Part B, spoken, running in parallel. While they write, take each student aside for 45 seconds: <i>Tell me about yourself.</i> Record on a tier grid: sentence length, verb accuracy, willingness to speak.	Eleven students at 45 seconds fits inside the 10 minutes with room to spare. Do not correct anything out loud during this stage. This is the single most useful 13 minutes of the unit.
45 to 52	Notebook and purpose	Set up the notebook: front page <i>UNIT 1: ME AND US</i> , then four tabbed sections (Vocabulary, Grammar, My writing, Homework). Hold up the mask and booklet example: <i>In six weeks, you will make this and present it. Everything we do goes into it.</i>	Sixty seconds on the final task is enough. The point is that they see the destination on day one.
52 to 55	Exit	Line up at the door. Each student must use one classroom English phrase, correctly, to leave.	Keeps the phrases alive and ends the lesson with every single student speaking English.

On the board, and copied into the notebook

My name is Louise. L-O-U-I-S-E.

I am eleven years old. I am from France. I am in 6e LVA.

Question: **What is** your name? **How old are** you? **Where are** you from?

The eight phrases: How do you say ... in English? / Can you repeat, please? / I do not understand. / How do you spell it? / Can I have a ...? / Sorry, I am late. / What page? / Can you help me?

Differentiation, 11 students in three working tiers

Tier	What they get	What success looks like today
Tier 1, support A0 to A1	Diagnostic slip with sentence starters printed: <i>My name is ... / I am ... years old. / I am from ... / I like ... / I have ...</i> Numbers strip reduced to the first four calculations.	Five completed frames, spoken name spelled out loud without help.
Tier 2, core A1 to A2	Plain diagnostic slip. Full numbers strip. Phone-number dictation at normal speed.	Five independent sentences, three of them with a correct form of <i>be</i> .
Tier 3, extend A2 to B1	Plain slip plus the extension prompt: <i>Now write three more sentences about one person in your family.</i> They dictate the phone numbers for their partner at speed.	Eight sentences, at least one with a subordinate clause or a connector.

Homework and assessment

Homework	Learn the eight classroom English phrases by heart, ready for a 60-second check at the start of Lesson 2. Cover the notebook and rule the four sections.
Assessment	Diagnostic, formative and ungraded. Transfer the results straight onto a tier grid at the back of your planner. This grid drives differentiation for the whole unit and decides the writing frames in Week 6 Lesson 2.

Watch out for

Do not mark the diagnostic in red and hand it back. It is intelligence for you, not feedback for them. A near-beginner who gets a covered-in-corrections page on day one will stop volunteering for six weeks.

French speakers reverse G and J when spelling. Fix it today, in the chain, while the stakes are zero. It will otherwise resurface in Week 5 when they spell their name for the acrostic.

The temptation is to teach more numbers. Resist it. Ordinals are Week 2 Lesson 2, tied to dates, where they have a purpose.